DERECH HASHEM: THE RAMHAL'S WAY OF GOD, AT TIFERET EYAL

What Is the Extra Soul of Shabbat?

Derech Hashem 3:1:4-5

Sefer: Derech Hashem by Rabbi Moshe Hayim Luzzatto (the Ramhal) **Section:** Part 3, Chapter 1, paragraphs 4-5 **Shiur:** Part of Dayan Daniel Kada's Derech Hashem series at Tiferet Eyal, Monday 25 October 2021

These notes are based on an automatic transcript of the recording.

Review: nefesh and neshamah

Every mammal, including human beings, has a nefesh. It gives us our characteristics, our survival instincts, our drives, imagination, intellect and desire. It is "the most physical spiritual thing there is": not physical, but the least spiritual entity, and it is tied to the blood, which is why the Torah says "the blood is the nefesh." As this week's parashah shows, nefesh can mean will: Avraham says to the people of Het, "im yesh et nafshekhem," if it is your will that I bury my dead. Our will to live comes from this animal instinct.

Human beings are unique in also having a neshamah, which connects us to the spiritual worlds. The neshamah is tied to the nefesh, and the nefesh to the blood. As learned in paragraph 3, the neshamah is subordinate and subdued because it lives in the body, and therefore limited. A participant asked whether it is constantly in conflict with the body. The Rabbi said it is subdued; it does not want to be there but has to be, and, as we will see, it can raise its awareness.

Paragraph 4: a chain of parts

The neshamah, which the Ramhal also calls the higher nefesh (as opposed to the lower, animal nefesh), is one entity, but it is divided into parts linked to one another like the rings of a chain. The lowest part of the neshamah is linked to the animal nefesh, and the animal nefesh is linked to the blood. The animal nefesh itself is not divided; "nefesh is nefesh," the same as in animals.

Paragraph 5: parts can be added and removed

Parts of the neshamah can leave a person and return, or be added at a later stage and then leave again. You will not notice this in your body. It cannot be sensed and does not change how you live or feel, because it is entirely intangible. Its significance lies in your inner identity and your connection with the higher spheres.

This is the idea of the extra soul (neshamah yeterah) received on Shabbat and lost on Mosei Shabbat. The point of receiving more is that you have greater access, "a bigger parking spot,"

more room to develop spiritually. That is why Shabbat is the time we grow most spiritually.

In the same way, it is said that a person who gets angry loses part of his neshamah. Not the whole of it, which would make him an animal, but certain parts. The Arizal taught a remedy based on gematria: kaas (anger) is 150, and mikveh is 151. A person who has been angry and lost part of his neshamah should immerse in a mikveh with teshuvah in mind, and the lost part returns.

A participant asked whether the extra soul of Shabbat is a separate soul or an angel. The Rabbi said no, that is something else entirely; it is an additional dimension of your own soul which you do not have during the week.

The five parts: Naranhai

The Ramhal names the five parts: nefesh, ruah, neshamah, hayah and yehidah. In Kabbalah they are abbreviated Naranhai. The Rabbi stressed not to confuse this nefesh with the animal nefesh: here nefesh is the lowest part of the neshamah, so called because it is the lowest. Ruah is second; neshamah is third, the middle and most important; hayah and yehidah are above. The lowest part, nefesh, is tied to the animal nefesh, which is tied to the blood.

On Shabbat, he said, you do not receive a sixth part but a more developed form of what you have, at least in three of the parts. He showed how this is reflected in the prayers, as marked in many siddurim: - **Friday night:** at "Boi kallah" one accepts the additional nefesh; at Barkhu, the additional ruah; and at the word "ufros" in Hashkivenu, the additional neshamah. That is why some people stand in the middle of Hashkivenu, and why they do not on Yom Tov, when there is no extra soul. - **Shabbat morning:** the additional nefesh is received in the mikveh, or if not, at Nishmat; the ruah at the Amidah of Shaharit; and the neshamah at "ayeh" in the Kedushah.

"People laugh at them, but these things have deep roots." He suggested that the custom of the congregation singing out "ayeh" began because the hazzan or rabbi would pause for a few seconds at that word to focus on receiving the extra neshamah, and it became established; "I bet you 95% of people screaming ayeh don't know what they're doing." What matters is not how long you pause but what you have in mind.

The three parts leave progressively: the neshamah straight away on Mosei Shabbat, which is why we smell besamim then; the ruah on Sunday night; and the nefesh on Monday night. Why no acceptance for the fourth and fifth parts? Because they are almost impossible to reach. The Zohar writes that only Moshe was truly in touch with the yehidah. When we speak of our soul we mean mainly nefesh, ruah and neshamah.

Can you feel it?

When I say "ayeh," I do not feel a neshamah coming in. Psychologically you might trick yourself, but you cannot feel it. And yet, the Ramhal continues, the neshamah has experiences of its own. Even though it is subdued and tied to the body, it still has some connection with the spiritual world, to the extent the body does not block it. This is not tangible or recognised by the mind; your mind cannot know how much you have received. Very rarely you will feel it.

This explains the Gemara's statement: "even though he did not see, his mazal saw." Something reached his neshamah but did not reach his conscious thought, or only a little. The Rabbi called it intuition: you feel something is right or wrong, or sense a spiritual connection, without knowing what it is. "It's like a sixth sense. Nobody can put their finger on what that sixth sense is, but it's there."

He added a caution. Perhaps 90% of the spiritual highs people feel in religious experiences are man-made. Put a hundred people together singing and dancing and you will feel high, but not because you received an extra soul; sometimes people work themselves up to cry or be emotional. The true thing is natural. "That's what being in touch with your neshamah really means. And the more in touch you are with the neshamah, the more you will have these intuitions." Next time: dreams.

Summary

- The neshamah (the higher nefesh) is a chain of parts; its lowest part links to the animal nefesh, which links to the blood.
- Parts of the neshamah can be added or lost without being felt; Shabbat brings extra measures, and anger can cost a part, restored, according to the Arizal, through mikveh and teshuvah.
- The five parts are nefesh, ruah, neshamah, hayah and yehidah; the extra nefesh, ruah and neshamah are received at set points in the Shabbat prayers and leave over the following three nights.
- We cannot sense these changes, but the neshamah can perceive things the mind does not, which is intuition: "his mazal saw."
- Most manufactured spiritual highs are not this; true intuition grows as one comes closer to one's neshamah.

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